

Day 20: Dashboard UI/UX & Data Storytelling

📌 Definition to Remember

Dashboard UI/UX Design is the science and art of structuring visual reports to enable effortless cognitive comprehension, clear visual hierarchy, and actionable data-driven decision making.

1. Principles of Enterprise Dashboard Layout

1. F-Pattern / Z-Pattern Visual Flow:

- Executive eye tracking starts at the **Top-Left** (place primary KPI cards here) and moves to bottom-right (place granular tables here).

2. Visual Hierarchy:

- *Tier 1 (Top)*: Headline KPIs (Sales, Margin, YoY Growth).
- *Tier 2 (Middle)*: Diagnostic charts (Trends over time, regional breakdown).
- *Tier 3 (Bottom)*: Operational details (Granular product matrix, transaction tables).

3. Intentional Color Theory:

- Use neutral backgrounds (**#121212** dark or **#F8F9FA** light).
- Reserve bright accent colors strictly for key insights, targets, and negative alerts (e.g., Red for missed SLA, Green for exceeded target).
- Never use more than 2-3 primary accent hues.

2. Navigation Architecture & Storytelling

- **Page Tabs vs Custom Icon Navigation**: Building sidebar nav bars with bookmark buttons.
- **Micro-Copy & Tooltip Guides**: Providing clear definitions and data refresh timestamps so business users understand metrics without confusion.

★ Must-Master Skills & Interview Points

1. The 5-Second Rule: An executive must understand overall business performance within 5 seconds of opening the dashboard.
2. Master whitespace balance, consistent padding, and standard font sizing (Headers 18-20pt, KPI values 24-32pt, Labels 9-10pt).
3. Designing accessible, high-contrast dashboards for all users.

⚡ Quick Recall

Top-Left KPIs (Tier 1) → Middle Trends (Tier 2) → Bottom Tables (Tier 3) | 5-Second Executive Rule